



Faith fulfilled: Peru's Neri Roxana Quispe crosses the finish line with her guide Aldo Milagro Huaman to win gold in the women's 1500m T11 at the World Para Athletics Championships — a victory built on years of faith, communication, and quiet perseverance. REUTERS

using subtle tugs and nudges to keep Simran within her lane. Any pulling or pushing would mean instant disqualification — as happened to the original winners in T12 women's 200m, Alejandra Pérez López and her guide Eubring Maza Caraballo of Venezuela.

For runners and their guides, trust is everything. The partnership goes beyond teamwork; it often feels closer to family.

Do jism, ek jaan (Two bodies, one life)

Runner: Simran Sharma

Guide: Umar Saifi

(India)

T12 women's 100m gold

T12 women's 200m silver

Simran: When people ask what it takes to form a guide and runner partnership, it's a very simple answer for me. Socho do jism, ek jaan (Think of it as two bodies having one life). A single person can't do anything. We are a team and have to work together. The goal isn't to be as fast as I can. It's about being fast together. It's important that both of us have the same mindset when it comes to sport.

We both have to train and prepare the same way. Just because Umar is my guide, it doesn't mean

that this medal means less to him.

He's someone who supports me a lot. I ran six races at this World Championships. I was very tired in the morning of the 100m final. I couldn't even bend my back. I was crying in the call room. But Umar told me you just get through today and then you can sleep for the next four-five days.

He knows when I'm getting agitated and he calms me down. I also think he's very lucky for me because I've never won two medals at a World Championships before. Later this month Umar will be competing at the Under-23 National Championships and I'll go with him to cheer for him. More than a guide, I see Umar as my *chhota bhai* (younger brother).

Umar: I've never actually run as a